

RevenueCat Shipaton 2026 – Complete Context

1. Event Overview

RevenueCat Shipaton 2026 is a mobile app shipping competition focused on launching a brand-new monetized application.

Core Challenge

Build and publicly release a **new mobile application** during the competition window.

The app must:

- Be a **brand-new application** that has never previously been publicly released.
- Be released for the **first time between August 1 and September 30, 2026**.
- Be available on at least one supported store:
 - Apple App Store
 - Google Play Store
 - Samsung Galaxy Store
- Integrate the **RevenueCat SDK**.
- Use RevenueCat to support at least one monetization method:
 - In-app purchase
 - Subscription
 - Web purchase
 - RevenueCat Ads, where applicable
- Be a working software application for:
 - iOS
 - iPadOS
 - macOS
 - Android

Updates to previously released applications **do not qualify**.

Official Timeline

- **Release/Submissions Open:** August 1, 2026
- **Release Deadline:** September 30, 2026
- **Submission Deadline:** September 30, 2026

3. Competition Categories

3.1 Grand Prize

Goal: Awarded to the application that demonstrates the strongest user traction and growth momentum during the competition.

Judges are interested in:

- User acquisition
- Growth momentum
- Post-launch growth strategies
- Execution after release
- Evidence that the team actively pushed the app beyond simply publishing it

Prize

- **1st Place:** \$100,000
- Trip to New York City
- Times Square billboard
- Shippy trophy
- Blog feature
- Media spotlight

3.2 Next Gen Award

Student-only category.

Eligible participants include active:

- High school students
- University students
- Bootcamp students
- Campus development club members
- Other active learners

Important Difference

This category has a lower-friction submission path.

Participants may submit:

- A video submission
- Open-source code

A paid Apple or Google developer account is **not required** for this category.

Judging Focus

- Quality of the application
- Video submission
- Open-source code

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

3.3 Catvertising Award

For the most creative and effective use of **RevenueCat Ads**.

Judges evaluate:

- Creative ad placements
- Smart integration with the overall monetization strategy
- Effective combination of ads and purchases/subscriptions
- User experience that does not feel intrusive or annoying

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

3.4 Best Game Award

For the best mobile game shipped during Shipaton.

Judges evaluate:

- Gameplay quality
- Art direction
- Overall polish
- Monetization strategy appropriate for the game genre

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

3.5 #BuildInPublic Award

For developers who publicly share an interesting and engaging development journey on social media.

Judges look for:

- Interesting development updates
- Valuable lessons learned

- Creative ideas
- Community engagement
- Consistent public progress
- Compelling storytelling

A dedicated Discord channel, #post-engagement-boost, exists for participants to share content and support each other's:

- Posts
- Videos
- YouTube content
- Launch announcements

Prize

- 1st: \$30,000
- 2nd: \$20,000
- 3rd: \$10,000

The 1st-place winner also receives:

- NYC travel
- Times Square billboard
- Shippy trophy
- Media spotlight

3.6 HAMM Award — Help Apps Make Money

For the project with the most robust and creative monetization strategy.

RevenueCat's core philosophy is:

Help Apps Make More Money.

Judges evaluate:

- Monetization strategy
- Revenue architecture
- Creative business model
- Revenue optimization
- Integration between product experience and monetization

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

3.7 RevenueCat Design Award

For the application that best demonstrates the craft of app development, regardless of business potential.

Judges evaluate:

- Innovative ideas
- Visual design
- UI quality
- UX quality
- Animations
- Overall product polish

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

3.8 RevenueCat Peace Prize

For the project providing the greatest social good.

Judges evaluate:

- Community benefit
- Social impact
- Real-world usefulness
- Potential benefit to society

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

4. Influencer Award Categories

4.1 Productivity — Christopher Lawley

Build a polished productivity application that gives Apple power users one fast, focused place to:

- Save reusable text snippets
- Save documents
- Save files
- Save images
- Quickly retrieve saved content

Judging focuses on:

- Product focus
- Speed
- Organization
- Intelligent features
- Overall design quality

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

4.2 Nutrition & Healthy Eating – Abbey's Kitchen

Build a flexible nutrition application inspired by Abbey's **Hunger Crushing Combo** framework.

The application should help users create more satisfying meals in real-life situations without:

- Calorie counting
- Macro tracking
- Restrictive meal plans

Judges look for:

- Compassionate design
- Practical usefulness
- Flexibility
- Real-world applicability
- Sustainable healthy eating guidance

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

4.3 Yoga & Fitness – Simone Sharice

Build a personalized wellness companion that answers:

"What should I do today?"

The application may support:

- Movement
- Pilates
- Recovery

- Wellness
- Daily activity planning

The goal is to turn complex wellness needs into a:

- Clear
- Personalized
- Achievable
- Daily plan

The experience should avoid creating additional information overload.

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

4.4 Career Coaching – Leadership Heather

Build an application helping new managers practice difficult workplace conversations before the real situation occurs.

Potential scenarios include:

- Giving feedback
- Setting boundaries
- Saying no
- Difficult conversations
- Leadership situations

Judges evaluate:

- Realistic scenarios
- Quality of feedback
- Confidence building
- Active practice
- Practical workplace relevance

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

4.5 Gaming – Mr Lewis Blogs Gaming

Build a gaming bucket-list application.

Users should be able to:

- Save games when discovered
- Organize games
- Track completion
- Rate games
- Share games

The backlog management experience should feel enjoyable rather than like another chore.

Prize

- 1st: \$20,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

5. Sponsor Categories

5.1 Ship Kotlin Everywhere — JetBrains

Recognizes a polished cross-platform application built using:

- Kotlin Multiplatform
- Compose Multiplatform
- Or both

Judges evaluate:

- Cross-platform quality
- Platform consistency
- Effective use of Kotlin
- Overall polish

Optional consideration may be given to:

- Useful build content
- Contributions to the Kotlin Multiplatform community

Prize

- 1st: \$15,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

5.2 Most Viral App — Noise

For the application that captures significant market attention through scalable content.

Judges evaluate:

- Virality
- Repeatable content formats
- Scalability
- Download conversion
- Clarity of app value
- Whether content addresses real user needs

Prize

- 1st: \$15,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

5.3 Best App for Galaxy – Samsung

Recognizes a high-quality application published on the **Samsung Galaxy Store**.

Judges evaluate:

- Overall app experience
- Samsung Galaxy optimization
- Foldable-device support
- Samsung-specific features
- Device performance

Galaxy Store exclusivity may receive bonus consideration but is **not required**.

Prize

The category includes:

- Invitation to App Growth Annual
- Times Square billboard
- Shippy trophy
- Blog feature
- Media spotlight
- **3 weeks of featured placement on the Galaxy Store**

5.4 Replit's Idea to Income

For a project using **Replit** to transform a new idea into a live monetizing mobile application.

Judges primarily evaluate:

- Week-over-week revenue growth
- Growth in transactions
- Paying-user traction

- Product quality
- Visual design
- Community engagement

Prize

- 1st: \$15,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

5.5 Keep Them Coming Back Award – OneSignal

For applications using OneSignal effectively to improve retention.

Judges evaluate:

- Quality of implementation
- Stability
- User value
- Creative use of:
 - Push notifications
 - Campaigns
 - Journeys
 - Advanced messaging
 - Lifecycle events

Prize

- 1st: \$25,000
- 2nd: \$15,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

5.6 The Growth Loop Award – Layers

For teams that treat growth as an iterative process of:

1. Testing
2. Measuring
3. Learning
4. Improving

Judges evaluate:

- Clear target audience
- Clear growth hypothesis
- Focused growth experiment
- Correct SDK installation
- Ability to observe results

- Lessons learned
- Planned next experiments

Prize

- 1st: \$15,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

5.7 Funnel Vision Award — Stripe

For projects launching a web funnel using:

- RevenueCat Funnels
- Stripe

Judges evaluate:

- Qualifying web payment volume
- Funnel design
- Functionality
- Implementation quality
- Effectiveness of the web-to-app conversion funnel

Prize

- 1st: \$15,000
- 2nd: \$10,000
- 3rd: \$5,000

6. Core Submission Requirements

Every standard Shipaton submission must include:

6.1 App Description

A clear text description explaining:

- What the app does
- Core features
- Functionality
- User value

6.2 Demo Video

The demo video must:

- Show the app running on the target device/platform

- Be no longer than **2 minutes of essential footage**
- Be publicly available
- Be uploaded to:
 - YouTube, or
 - Vimeo
- Avoid unlicensed:
 - Third-party trademarks
 - Copyrighted music
 - Copyrighted material

Judges are **not required to watch beyond 2 minutes**.

6.3 Published App URL

Provide a public URL for the application on at least one supported store:

- App Store
- Google Play Store
- Samsung Galaxy Store

6.4 App Icon

Provide a:

- **1024 × 1024 pixel app icon**

6.5 App Screenshot

Provide at least one screenshot:

- **1179 × 2556 pixels**
- No device frame

6.6 Premium Access for Judges

Provide either:

- A free trial, or
- A promo code

Judges must be able to unlock premium functionality and test all paid features.

7. RevenueCat Requirement

The project must integrate the **RevenueCat SDK**.

The SDK must power at least one monetization mechanism, such as:

- In-app purchase
- Subscription
- Web purchase
- Ads through RevenueCat Ads, where applicable

The RevenueCat integration should be:

- Functional
- Properly tested
- Connected to the application's monetization strategy

8. Ship Kit

The **Ship Kit** provides free tools, credits, discounts, and resources to help participants build, launch, monetize, and grow their applications.

Perks unlock automatically as participants reach milestones.

How It Works

1. Register for Shipaton on Devpost.
2. Complete the participant form.
3. Receive initial Ship Kit perks.
4. Progress through milestones.
5. Additional perks unlock automatically by email.

9. Ship Kit Milestones

Milestone 1 — Registration Complete

Requirements:

- Register for Shipaton
- Complete the participant form

Milestone 2 — RevenueCat Project Created

Requirements:

- Create a Project
- Create an App inside the RevenueCat account

Milestone 3 — First Test Purchase

Requirements:

- Test the monetization flow

- Use RevenueCat's test environment/store

Milestone 4 — First Store API Call

Requirements:

- Connect the application to a real store:
 - App Store
 - Google Play
 - Galaxy Store

Triggered by using a **real Store API key** rather than a Test Store API key.

Milestone 5 — First Real Purchase

Requirements:

- Application is live
- A successful real purchase occurs

RevenueCat automatically detects milestones and sends available perks and redemption instructions.

10. Ship Kit Perks

10.1 Registration Perks

Replit

- 40% off Replit Pro
- \$40 discount

Additional opportunity:

- Eligible for the Replit-sponsored prize category

OneSignal

- 100% off Growth Plan
- Up to 3 months

Supports:

- Push notifications
- In-app messaging
- Email
- SMS

Can integrate with RevenueCat lifecycle subscription events.

JetBrains

- Free access to Junie for 2 months
- Limited to 200 redemptions

Noise

- \$1,000 in matching credits

Matching model:

- For every \$1 spent on creators, Noise matches the spend dollar-for-dollar.

Layers

- Free access for 2 months

Supports:

- Content generation
- Paid ads
- Social media
- App Store listing optimization
- Marketing automation

Stripe

- \$250 in Stripe credits

Useful for:

- Web subscriptions
- Web-to-app funnels
- Checkout flows

Argent

- Free access

Agentic toolkit that can help AI coding assistants:

- Run applications
- Detect bugs
- Fix issues

Works with tools including:

- Cursor
- Claude

- Copilot

Bitrig

- 60% off Bitrig Pro

Supports AI-assisted native Swift app development with built-in:

- App Store Connect integration
- RevenueCat integration

Codemagic

- Free tier
- 500 build minutes per month

Supports:

- Mobile CI/CD
- Builds
- Code signing
- App store deployment
- OTA updates for React Native

Emergent

- 200 free credits
- Approximate value: \$40

AI application builder with RevenueCat integration.

Lance

- Free access for 3 months
- Approximate value: \$180

Supports:

- App Store builds
- Signing
- In-app purchases
- Submission

lim.run

- 2,000 credits
- Approximate value: \$100

Provides mobile development infrastructure for:

- iOS simulators
- Android emulators
- Xcode build environments
- AI agents

OpenRouter

- \$10 credit

Provides unified access to hundreds of AI models through a single API.

Tenjin

- All-Inclusive Plan S
- Free for 3 months
- Approximate value: \$600

Supports:

- Mobile attribution
- Campaign measurement
- Revenue tracking

10.2 RevenueCat Project Created Perks

Mobbin

- 3 months free

Mobile and web design reference library.

Paddle

- No fees on the first \$100,000 in transaction volume

Tminus

- 80% off Pro Plan
- 3 months

Supports:

- App Store submission automation
- Compliance
- Metadata
- Screenshots
- Resubmission after rejection

10.3 First Test Purchase Perks

AppScreens

- 50% off Pro or Scale

Supports:

- Store screenshots
- Localization
- Multiple required sizes
- ASO variants

Aspty

- 30-day free trial
- Dedicated Apple Search Ads specialist

Linearity

- 50% off entire suite

Supports AI-assisted creation of:

- Social posts
- Ads
- App Store graphics
- Campaign assets

Sentry

- \$100 in credits

Supports:

- Error tracking
- Performance monitoring
- Session replays

10.4 First Store API Call Perks

Airbridge

- Airbridge GO: 2 months free
- Limited to 100 redemptions

Also:

- Core plan free for 6 months
- Approximate value: \$240

AppFollow

- 50% off for 6 months

Supports:

- ASO monitoring
- Rating management
- Review responses

AppTweak

- 50% off

Supports:

- Keyword research
- Competitor analysis
- App ranking insights

10.5 First Real Purchase Perks

Appstack

- Full access for free

Supports:

- Ad attribution
- Revenue attribution
- Personalized paywalls

Fload

- Full access for free

Can combine:

- App Store data
- Ad platform data
- RevenueCat data

Supports AI-assisted analytics queries.

11. Bonus Milestones

JetBrains IntelliJ

- Free IntelliJ IDEA Ultimate
- 3 months

Automatically unlocks for:

- Kotlin Multiplatform builders

Stripe Projects

- \$250 in credits

Automatically unlocks when:

- RevenueCat account and/or project is provisioned via Stripe Projects
- A real purchase occurs by September 30, 2026

12. Build-in-Public Strategy

The competition strongly supports public development and growth sharing.

Recommended public content can include:

- Idea announcement
- Build progress
- Feature reveals
- Problems encountered
- Lessons learned
- UI evolution
- Monetization experiments
- User feedback
- Launch preparation
- Launch announcement
- Growth experiments
- Revenue milestones, where appropriate

Use:

#Shipaton

The official Discord provides community support and a dedicated engagement channel for sharing content.

13. Growth and Monetization Opportunities

The competition rewards more than simply building a functional application.

Strong projects may combine multiple dimensions:

Product

- Useful idea
- Strong execution
- High-quality user experience

Monetization

- RevenueCat integration
- Subscription strategy
- One-time purchases
- Ads
- Web funnel
- Stripe integration

Growth

- Build in public
- Viral content
- User acquisition
- Growth experiments
- Community engagement

Retention

- OneSignal
- Push notifications
- Lifecycle messaging
- User journeys

Analytics

- Attribution
- Funnel tracking
- Revenue measurement
- Experiment analysis

14. Strategic Category Combinations

A single application may potentially be designed to compete strongly across multiple compatible categories.

Possible combinations include:

Growth-Focused App

Potential categories:

- Grand Prize

- #BuildInPublic
- Most Viral App
- Replit's Idea to Income
- Growth Loop Award
- Keep Them Coming Back

Monetization-Focused App

Potential categories:

- Grand Prize
- HAMM Award
- Funnel Vision Award
- Catvertising Award

Highly Polished Consumer App

Potential categories:

- Grand Prize
- RevenueCat Design Award
- Best App for Galaxy
- Most Viral App

Student Project

Potential categories may include:

- Next Gen Award
- Relevant product category
- RevenueCat Design Award
- #BuildInPublic
- Growth-related sponsor categories

Exact eligibility should always be checked against the official category rules.

15. Available Technical Resources

RevenueCat provides resources for:

General

- RevenueCat SDK documentation
- Codelabs
- Zero to Ship resources
- Google Play integration
- App Store integration
- Troubleshooting

Android

- [Android SDK documentation](#)
- [In-app purchases and paywalls codelabs](#)

iOS

- [iOS and Apple documentation](#)
- [In-app purchases and paywalls codelabs](#)

React Native

- [React Native documentation](#)
- [Expo documentation](#)
- [In-app purchases and paywalls codelabs](#)

Kotlin Multiplatform

- [Kotlin Multiplatform documentation](#)
- [Purchases and paywalls codelabs](#)

Flutter

- [Flutter documentation](#)
- [Purchases and paywalls codelabs](#)

Additional resources include:

- [RevenueCat AI Toolkits](#)
- [Product videos](#)
- [IntelliJ IDE plugin](#)

16. Product Hunt

Product Hunt provides a guide for launching a Shipaton application on Product Hunt.

This can potentially support:

- Visibility
- Launch traction
- User acquisition
- Viral growth
- Community engagement

RevenueCat Shipaton 2026 – Critical Rules and Strategic Summary

1. Key Dates

- **Submission deadline:** September 30, 2026, at **11:45 PM PDT**
- **Judging period:** October 1–13, 2026
- **Winners announced:** October 21, 2026

2. Core Project Requirements

A qualifying project must:

- Be a working application for:
 - Android
 - iOS
 - iPadOS
 - macOS
- Integrate the **RevenueCat SDK**
- Include at least one monetization mechanism:
 - In-app purchase
 - Web purchase
 - RevenueCat Ads integration
- Function correctly and visibly in the demo submission

The project should be a genuinely working application rather than a concept, mockup, or incomplete prototype.

3. Store Publishing Requirement

For most Shipaton categories, the app must be publicly published before the deadline on at least one supported store:

- Google Play Store
- Apple App Store
- Samsung Galaxy Store

Important Exception: Next Gen Award

The **Next Gen Award** does not require App Store, Google Play, or Galaxy Store publishing.

Instead, participants must generally provide:

- Active student status
- A qualifying academic/student email
- A working project

- Demo video
- Public GitHub or code repository
- Open-source license

This significantly reduces publishing friction and makes Next Gen strategically important for eligible student participants.

4. Submission Checklist

A standard Shipaton submission generally requires:

- Working application
- RevenueCat SDK integration
- At least one qualifying monetization mechanism
- Clear project description
- Demo video under 2 minutes
- Video showing the app actually working
- Public YouTube or Vimeo video link
- 1024 × 1024 app icon
- At least one 1179 × 2556 screenshot
- Screenshot without a device frame
- Published store URL, unless qualifying for the Next Gen exception
- Free trial or promo code allowing judges to access premium features

5. Multiple Category Strategy

A single project may target multiple compatible **non-Influencer categories**, provided it independently meets every category's requirements.

For example, one project may potentially target:

- Next Gen Award
- RevenueCat Design Award
- HAMM Award
- #BuildInPublic Award
- The Growth Loop Award
- Keep Them Coming Back Award
- Best App for Galaxy

Restriction

Each project can enter **only one Influencer Award category**.

6. Strategic Category Combinations

Option A — Lowest Publishing Pressure

Next Gen + #BuildInPublic

Advantages:

- No store publishing requirement for Next Gen
- Focus on product quality, code, and presentation
- Public build updates can simultaneously strengthen #BuildInPublic eligibility
- Lower risk of store approval delays
- Easier to focus on polishing the product itself

This is a strong strategy for a student project.

Option B — Maximum Category Stacking

If the project is published as an Android application, a broader strategy may include:

- Next Gen
- RevenueCat Design Award
- HAMM Award
- #BuildInPublic
- Keep Them Coming Back Award
- The Growth Loop Award
- Best App for Galaxy

However, each additional category may introduce extra requirements involving:

- Technical integrations
- Growth experiments
- Push notifications
- Monetization
- Galaxy-specific optimization
- Store publishing
- Documentation and evidence

The goal should be **strategic overlap**, not adding integrations solely to enter more categories.

7. What Major Categories Actually Reward

Category	Primary Evaluation Focus
Grand Prize	Real revenue, user growth, traction, momentum
Next Gen	Strong student project, open-source code, presentation, RevenueCat use
RevenueCat Design Award	Beautiful UI, animations, polish, innovative experience
HAMM Award	Creative and robust monetization strategy
#BuildInPublic	Public development journey, lessons, feedback, engagement
Keep Them Coming Back	Effective OneSignal implementation and re-engagement
Growth Loop Award	Growth experiments, testing, measurement, learning
Best App for Galaxy	Galaxy Store publishing and Samsung-specific optimization
Most Viral App	Scalable, high-performing viral content and attention
Idea to Income	Replit-built app with real monetization and growth
RevenueCat Peace Prize	Strong social impact and meaningful benefit to society

8. Grand Prize Strategy

The **\$100,000 Grand Prize** is not simply awarded to the most technically impressive or beautifully designed application.

RevenueCat uses real business and growth performance during the competition period to identify strong candidates.

Important factors include:

- Early release
- Real users
- Growth
- Installs
- Revenue
- Paying customers
- Retention
- Marketing experiments
- Growth momentum

Strategic Implication

Shipping early is extremely important.

A project released near the end of September may have little time to:

- Acquire users
- Test marketing
- Generate revenue
- Improve retention
- Run experiments
- Demonstrate momentum

For Grand Prize ambitions, the preferred strategy is:

Build quickly → Launch early → Measure → Improve → Grow.

9. #BuildInPublic Strategy

A large existing audience is not necessarily required.

Judges care about the quality and value of the public journey, including:

- Development updates
- Interesting challenges
- Lessons learned
- Product decisions
- Community feedback
- How feedback improved the product
- Growth experiments
- Launch preparation
- Launch results

Recommended hashtags:

- **#Shipaton**
- **#BuildInPublic**

A good strategy is to document progress while building rather than treating content creation as a separate project.

Potential content:

- "Building Day 1" announcement
- Feature progress
- UI before/after comparisons
- Technical challenges
- User feedback
- Monetization decisions
- Failed experiments
- Launch preparation
- Growth experiments
- Lessons learned

10. Next Gen Award – Strategic Importance

Next Gen is particularly attractive because it removes the normal store publishing requirement.

Key Requirements

- Active student status
- Qualifying academic/student email
- Working project
- Demo video
- Public code repository
- Open-source license

Major Advantage

The application does **not necessarily need to be published on an app store** for this category.

This reduces risks involving:

- Developer account costs
- Store review delays
- Store rejection
- Publishing configuration
- Release timing

Prize Structure

- 🏆 1st Place: **\$15,000**
- 🥈 2nd Place: **\$10,000**
- 🥉 3rd Place: **\$5,000**

11. Best App for Galaxy Strategy

To compete for **Best App for Galaxy**, the application should:

- Be published on the Samsung Galaxy Store during Shipaton
- Provide the Galaxy Store URL
- Clearly explain Galaxy-specific optimization

Potential advantages include:

- Foldable-device support
- Multi-window support
- Large-screen optimization
- Samsung-specific features
- Strong device performance

A meaningful portion of judging focuses specifically on **Galaxy optimization**.

For an Android application, this can be a valuable additional category if Samsung-specific improvements are natural for the product.

12. Multiple Project Submissions

Participants may submit more than one project.

Each project must be:

- Unique
- Substantially different from other submissions

The rules may also allow participants to:

- Join multiple teams
- Compete individually
- Participate through an organization

However, building multiple projects should only be considered if doing so does not significantly reduce the quality and launch readiness of the strongest project.

13. Intellectual Property Requirements

Projects must:

- Be original
- Be owned by the participant or team
- Avoid infringing third-party intellectual property

Participants may use:

- Open-source libraries
- Third-party APIs
- SDKs
- Other permitted development tools

However, all applicable licenses and terms must be followed.

Next Gen Additional Requirement

The repository must be:

- Public
- Open source
- Released under an appropriate open-source license

14. Major Prize Values

Category	1st Place
 Grand Prize	\$100,000
#BuildInPublic	\$30,000
Keep Them Coming Back / OneSignal	\$25,000
Most major standard categories	\$15,000–\$20,000
Next Gen	\$15,000

15. Recommended Strategic Priority

When evaluating a project for Shipaton 2026, prioritize categories in approximately this order:

Tier 1 — High Strategic Value

1. **Next Gen Award**
2. **#BuildInPublic**
3. **RevenueCat Design Award**

These can reward:

- Product quality
- Presentation
- Public journey
- Design
- Technical execution

without relying entirely on high revenue.

Tier 2 — Strong Additional Opportunities

1. **HAMM Award**
2. **Best App for Galaxy**, if Android
3. **Keep Them Coming Back**, if OneSignal meaningfully fits
4. **Growth Loop Award**, if growth experiments can be measured

Tier 3 — Higher Difficulty / Traction Dependent

1. **Grand Prize**
2. **Most Viral App**
3. **Idea to Income**

These generally benefit significantly from:

- Early launch
- Strong user acquisition
- Revenue
- Repeatable marketing
- Real growth momentum

16. LLM Instructions for Future Project Evaluation

Use this context when evaluating any proposed RevenueCat Shipaton 2026 project.

For every idea, analyze:

A. Eligibility

Determine whether the idea can satisfy:

- New app requirement

- RevenueCat requirement
- Monetization requirement
- Next Gen eligibility
- Store publishing requirements
- Open-source requirements

B. Category Fit

Identify all categories the project could realistically target.

Separate them into:

- Strong fit
- Possible fit
- Weak/stretch fit

C. Build Feasibility

Evaluate:

- MVP complexity
- Development time
- Mobile development requirements
- Backend requirements
- API dependencies
- Publishing difficulty
- Integration complexity

D. Competitive Potential

Score:

- Originality
- Design potential
- Monetization potential
- Viral potential
- Growth potential
- Social impact
- Technical polish
- Demonstration potential

E. Strategic Recommendation

Recommend:

- The best category combination
- Minimum viable feature set
- Features to postpone

- Best monetization model
- Whether early publishing is necessary
- Whether Samsung Galaxy Store support is worthwhile
- Whether OneSignal is worthwhile
- Whether the idea is worth pursuing compared with alternatives

F. Final Decision

Give a clear verdict:

- **Strong candidate**
- **Good but risky**
- **Possible but weak strategically**
- **Not recommended**

The primary objective is not merely to build an app. The objective is to build the **strongest realistically shippable project with the highest possible category overlap and winning potential before September 30, 2026.**